

Title

Optimized Nursing Protocols for Hip Replacement Recovery in Older Patients: Study Design

Abstract

Background: Older adults undergoing hip replacement face prolonged recovery and functional limitations. Enhanced recovery protocols have shown promise in surgical populations.

Methods: This single-blind randomized trial will evaluate a structured nursing protocol designed to optimize recovery following hip arthroplasty in 90 patients aged 60 years or older. Participants will be randomized to receive either an optimized multi-component nursing intervention (ERAS protocol) or standard postoperative nursing care. The ERAS protocol comprises enhanced pain management, nutritional optimization, early mobilization, catheter management, temperature regulation, and drainage tube care. Outcomes assessed include pain scores, time to first bowel function, time to ambulation, removal of catheters and drains, hip function scores, independence in activities of daily living, complication rates, hospital length of stay, and patient satisfaction. Assessors evaluating outcomes will remain blinded to group assignment. Data will be collected preoperatively and at multiple postoperative intervals. This study aims to determine whether structured nursing interventions can reduce morbidity and hospitalization duration in older hip replacement patients.